

D072

Fundamentals for Success in Business

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A manager at a bakery chain with 11 locations, promoted from assistant manager last year, compares each store's monthly sales with its target and meets with managers whose stores fall short to agree on fixes. Which management function is this?

- A. Planning
- B. Controlling
- C. Leading
- D. Organizing, since every management task is organizing

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which activity is an example of organizing?

- A. Setting next year's sales goals
- B. Grouping jobs into departments and assigning tasks
- C. Measuring results against targets
- D. Motivating staff through a tough quarter

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A software company that recently moved to a new campus removes two layers of middle management. Each remaining manager now supervises 15 people instead of 5, and front-line teams make more decisions on their own. How has the structure changed?

- A. Taller, with a narrower span of control
- B. Flatter but more centralized
- C. Unchanged, because removing layers does not affect span of control
- D. Flatter, with a wider span of control and more decentralization

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company hiring many new, inexperienced staff wants close supervision. What span of control fits best?

- A.** A narrow span of control
- B.** More decentralized decision-making
- C.** A wide span of control
- D.** No managers at all, with self-managed teams

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A research lab funded by a five-year grant and housed in a converted warehouse has a team of experienced, self-motivated scientists working on open-ended problems. Which leadership style fits best?

- A.** Autocratic
- B.** Transactional, with close monitoring of each task
- C.** Delegative (laissez-faire)
- D.** Democratic, since voting is best for every decision

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A manager must tell an employee that their position is being eliminated. The company recently adopted a team chat app that 95% of staff use daily. Which channel is best?

- A.** A company-wide email
- B.** A private face-to-face meeting
- C.** A direct message in the chat app
- D.** Any channel, as long as the wording is clear

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A manager whose office is on the fourth floor next to the break room has just fixed a server outage. Her list still has: answer a coworker's minor question about parking, plan next year's staff training, and read industry news headlines. Which task deserves scheduled, protected time?

- A. Planning next year's staff training
- B. Whatever request arrives next
- C. Answering the parking question
- D. Reading industry headlines

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A task is urgent but not important. What is the best way to handle it?

- A. Schedule it for later
- B. Drop it entirely
- C. Do it yourself first
- D. Delegate it

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

An analyst with an MBA and eight years in logistics is sharply criticized in a meeting. She feels angry, pauses, takes a breath, and says she will respond after reviewing the data. Which emotional intelligence component is she showing?

- A. Social skill
- B. Self-awareness
- C. Suppressing emotion, which is always best at work
- D. Self-regulation

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which behavior best shows empathy?

- A.** Noticing a coworker seems withdrawn after a reorganization and asking how it is affecting them
- B.** Agreeing with everyone to avoid conflict
- C.** Recognizing your own frustration before a meeting
- D.** Persuading the team to adopt your plan

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

Customer complaints at an online retailer rose 30% this quarter. The company recently redesigned its logo. In the first meeting, the team proposes hiring ten more service reps. What should happen first?

- A.** Hire the reps right away.
- B.** Go back to the old logo.
- C.** Analyze the complaints to define the problem and find the root cause.
- D.** Refund every customer who complains.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A manager at a regional grocery chain with 2,000 employees chooses the store-closing plan that produces the most total benefit for the most people, even though a few employees are harmed. Which ethical framework is this?

- A.** Rights or duty-based
- B.** Legal compliance, which always equals ethics
- C.** Utilitarian
- D.** Justice or fairness

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A manager at a bakery chain ~~with 11 locations, promoted from assistant manager last year,~~ compares each store's monthly sales with its target and meets with managers whose stores fall short to agree on fixes. Which management function is this?

Target word: which function **Decides:** Comparing results with targets and correcting.

A	Adjacent category	Planning set the targets; this step checks against them.
B	Correct	Measuring performance against standards and correcting is controlling.
C	Confusion set	Leading is motivating and directing, not measuring results.
D	Absolute language	The functions are distinct.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

Which activity is an example of organizing?

Target word: pick the organizing activity **Decides:** Arranging people and tasks.

A	Adjacent category	That is planning.
B	Correct	Organizing arranges resources and roles.
C	Inverted operation	That is controlling, the last function.
D	Confusion set	That is leading.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A software company ~~that recently moved to a new campus~~ removes two layers of middle management. Each remaining manager now supervises 15 people instead of 5, and front-line teams make more decisions on their own. How has the structure changed?

Target word: direction of structural change **Decides:** Fewer layers, more reports per manager, decisions pushed down.

A	Inverted operation	The opposite of removing layers.
B	Confusion set	Teams now decide more, which is decentralization.
C	Dropped element	Drops the link between layers and spans.
D	Correct	Removing layers widens spans and pushes decisions down.

4. Answer A Concept 2 • transfer

A company hiring many new, inexperienced staff wants close supervision. What span of control fits best?

Target word: span for close supervision **Decides:** Close supervision needs fewer reports per manager.

A	Correct	Fewer reports allow closer supervision.
B	Adjacent category	Moves decisions away from managers, the opposite of close supervision.
C	Inverted operation	Wide spans reduce supervision per person.
D	Absolute language	An extreme that removes supervision entirely.

5. Answer C Concept 3

A research lab ~~funded by a five-year grant and housed in a converted warehouse~~ has a team of experienced, self-motivated scientists working on open-ended problems. Which leadership style fits best?

Target word: style that fits **Decides:** Skilled, self-motivated experts.

A	Inverted operation	Fits crises or inexperienced teams, the opposite case.
B	Adjacent category	Close monitoring clashes with open-ended expert work.
C	Correct	Experts who are self-driven do best with autonomy.
D	Absolute language	No one style is best everywhere.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A manager must tell an employee that their position is being eliminated. ~~The company recently adopted a team chat app that 95% of staff use daily.~~ Which channel is best?

Target word: channel for sensitive news **Decides:** Personal, emotional news needs a rich channel.

A	Adjacent category	Lean, public, and wrong for a personal message.
B	Correct	Rich channels carry tone and allow questions.
C	Camouflage	Popularity does not make a lean channel right for bad news.
D	Absolute language	Channel choice matters for sensitive news.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A manager ~~whose office is on the fourth floor next to the break room~~ has just fixed a server outage. Her list still has: answer a coworker's minor question about parking, plan next year's staff training, and read industry news headlines. Which task deserves scheduled, protected time?

Target word: important, not urgent **Decides:** Training strategy is important but not urgent.

A	Correct	Important but not urgent work is what gets crowded out unless scheduled.
B	Dropped element	Drops importance from the decision.
C	Confusion set	Urgent-feeling but not important; delegate or batch it.
D	Inverted operation	Neither urgent nor important.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

A task is urgent but not important. What is the best way to handle it?

Target word: handling for urgent, not important **Decides:** Delegate.

A	Inverted operation	That rule is for important, not urgent tasks.
B	Confusion set	That rule is for tasks that are neither.
C	Adjacent category	That rule is for urgent and important tasks.
D	Correct	Someone else can handle it without costing you important time.

9. Answer D Concept 6

An analyst ~~with an MBA and eight years in logistics~~ is sharply criticized in a meeting. She feels angry, pauses, takes a breath, and says she will respond after reviewing the data. Which emotional intelligence component is she showing?

Target word: EI component **Decides:** She manages her reaction.

A	Confusion set	Social skill is managing relationships, not her own impulse.
B	Adjacent category	She noticed her anger, but the action shown is managing it.
C	Absolute language	EI is managing emotion, not always hiding it.
D	Correct	Controlling an impulse and responding calmly is self-regulation.

10. Answer A Concept 6 · transfer

Which behavior best shows empathy?

Target word: pick empathy **Decides:** Reading and responding to others' feelings.

A	Correct	Empathy is sensing others' emotions.
B	Confusion set	Avoiding conflict is not understanding others.
C	Inverted operation	That looks inward: self-awareness.
D	Adjacent category	That is social skill.

11. Answer C Concept 7

Customer complaints at an online retailer rose 30% this quarter. ~~The company recently redesigned its logo.~~ In the first meeting, the team proposes hiring ten more service reps. What should happen first?

Target word: first problem-solving step **Decides:** The cause of the complaints is unknown.

A	Dropped element	Skips diagnosis; the cause may be shipping, not staffing.
B	Camouflage	Nothing links the logo to complaints.
C	Correct	Solutions should follow a verified cause.
D	Adjacent category	Treats the symptom, not the cause.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A manager at a regional grocery chain ~~with 2,000 employees~~ chooses the store-closing plan that produces the most total benefit for the most people, even though a few employees are harmed. Which ethical framework is this?

Target word: framework **Decides:** Judges by total outcomes.

A	Inverted operation	Duty-based ethics judges the act itself, not total outcomes.
B	Absolute language	Legal and ethical are not the same.
C	Correct	Greatest good for the greatest number.
D	Adjacent category	Focuses on fair distribution, not the total benefit.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	10	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	The four management functions	Planning sets goals; organizing arranges people and tasks; leading motivates and directs; controlling measures results and corrects.	Calling target-setting controlling, or measurement planning.	A verb in the stem: set, assign, motivate, compare and correct.
2	Span of control and structure	Fewer layers means wider spans and a flatter, usually more decentralized structure; narrow spans mean taller structures and closer supervision.	Thinking removing layers narrows spans or centralizes decisions.	Layers removed or added, and reports per manager.
3	Matching leadership style to the situation	Directive styles fit crises and inexperienced teams; participative styles fit engaged teams; delegative (laissez-faire) fits skilled, self-motivated experts.	Believing one style is best everywhere.	The team's skill and motivation, and how urgent the situation is.
4	Channel richness	Sensitive, complex or personal messages need rich channels (face-to-face); routine facts can go by lean channels (email, chat).	Choosing the most convenient or popular channel.	Bad news, conflict or ambiguity in the message.
5	Urgent vs. important	Do urgent and important now; schedule important but not urgent; delegate urgent but not important; drop neither.	Letting urgent trivia crowd out important planning.	A to-do list mixing interruptions with long-term work.
6	Emotional intelligence components	Self-awareness (know your emotions), self-regulation (manage them), motivation, empathy (read others), social skill (manage relationships).	Confusing noticing your own emotion with controlling it, or empathy with social skill.	Whether the person acts on their own feelings or on others'.
7	Define the problem before solving it	Identify and verify the root cause before generating solutions.	Jumping to the first obvious fix.	A symptom and a proposed solution with no analysis between.
8	Ethical frameworks	Utilitarian = greatest good for the greatest number; rights / duty-based = follow duties regardless of outcome; justice = fair distribution.	Equating legal with ethical, or mixing outcome-based and duty-based reasoning.	Reasoning from outcomes vs. from duties or fairness.

Course scope (public description): This introductory course provides students with an overview of the field of business and a basic understanding of how management, organizational structure, communication, and leadership styles affect the business environment. It also introduces them to some of the power skills that help make successful business professionals, including time management, problem solving, emotional intelligence and innovation; while also teaching them the importance of ethics. This course gives students an opportunity to begin to explore their own strengths and passions in relation to the field while also acclimating them to the online competency-based environment.